

Regular Meeting
May 7, 2018
School Committee Meeting
Council Chambers

The regular meeting of the Medford School Committee was called to order by Mayor Burke in the City Hall Council Chambers at 7:07 p.m. Those present were Ms. DiBenedetto, Ms. Kreatz, Ms. Mustone, Mr. Ruggiero, Mr. Ruseau, Ms. Van der Kloot, Mayor Burke and Superintendent Belson. Also present was Medford High School Student Representative Justin Tseng.

On the motion of Ms. Van der Kloot to suspend the rules to take papers out of order to elect the next Superintendent of Schools:

Vote:

Yes: 7
No: 0
Absent: 0

Mayor Burke informed the community that the committee had voted in the Committee of the Whole meeting to elect Dr. Marice Edouard –Vincente as the next Superintendent of Schools and we are taking the formal vote in public. Members spoke about the process of selection and both finalists.

On the motion of Ms. Van der Kloot seconded by Ms. DiBenedetto to elect Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincente as the next Superintendent of Schools and to begin negotiations as soon as possible:

Roll Call:

Yea: 7 DiBenedetto, Kreatz, Mustone, Ruggiero, Ruseau, Van der Kloot, Burke
Nay: 0
Absent: 0

On the motion of Van der Kloot seconded by Mr. Ruseau to revert back to the regular order of business:

Vote:

Yes: 7
No: 0
Absent: 0

On the motion of Mr. Ruseau seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot that the minutes of April 9, 2018 be approved:

Ms. DiBenedetto said that two items that she had requested were not reflected in the minutes. She asked for the minutes to be amended to include her comments regarding COLA for secretaries and the definition of newly hired and asked that the minutes be tabled until next meeting.

On the motion of Ms. DiBenedetto seconded by Ms. Mustone that the Bills/Transfer of Funds be approved:

Voted: That the Bills/Transfer of Funds be approved.

Roll Call:

Yea: 7 DiBenedetto, Kreatz, Mustone, Ruggiero, Ruseau, Van der Kloot, Burke

Nay: 0

Absent: 0

On the motion of Ms. DiBenedetto seconded by Mr. Ruggiero a five minute recess was held at 7:28 p.m.

The meeting reconvened at 7:48 p.m.

On the motion of Mr. Ruseau seconded Ms. DiBenedetto by that the Payrolls be approved:

Voted: That the Payrolls be approved

Roll Call:

Yea: 7 DiBenedetto, Kreatz, Mustone, Ruggiero, Ruseau, Van der Kloot, Burke

Nay: 0

Absent: 0

On the motion of Ms. Van der Kloot seconded by Mr. Ruseau to take papers out of order:

Vote:

Yes: 7

No: 0

Absent: 0

Report on Student Award

Associate Director of the Vocational School Jill Sawyer introduced teacher Norm Rousseau and student Christina Lane. Mr. Rousseau explained the award that Christina received. She was the Grand Prize winner in the Biogen Foundation Spark Video Contest. Christina thanked her teachers and fellow classmate for helping in the video production. Christina was presented with a certificate from the Committee.

On the motion of Ms. Van der Kloot seconded by Ms. DiBenedetto the report was accepted and placed on file.

Vote:

Yes: 7

No: 0

Absent: 0

Also while under suspension: Community Participation

President of the Medford Paraprofessionals Association Gina Capolla and President of the Medford Teachers Association Charlene Douglas were given permission to speak. Ms. Capolla stated that the paraprofessionals union agrees with the MTA. Ms. Douglas said that she was speaking on behalf of the McGlynn teachers and paraprofessionals regarding the statements in the Medford Police report. She said that they are troubled by the inconsistencies in the statements contained in the report. She continued with many examples of information contained in the report. Ms. Douglas said that the staff is asking; no demanding a public apology from the

Superintendent and to be assured that the School Committee doesn't share the negative comments about the McGlynn staff.

Many McGlynn teachers spoke about the subject and the wonderful things being done at the McGlynn.

Superintendent Belson said that at no time have I said the McGlynn is a bad school or said teachers are not doing their job. He spoke about the different scenarios and the gaps that raise questions.

Chief Sacco stated that the schools in Medford are safe because of the staff working in them. In regards to the report he said that it is better than a summary but you can't put down every word. He said that Mr. Belson was very open and honest. He wanted to leave no stone unturned. He gave the Captain information about the climate at the school. Mr. Belson didn't want to put anyone under the bus. He took the blame. He also stated that they have no answers to the following questions: How did the magazine get there? Who did it belong to? How did it get out of the office?

Mr. Belson said that he didn't name any individual. He took the blame and if anyone feels offended then you have my apology. It was not my intent; the goal was to aid the police department.

Many School Committee members and community participants commented on the subject. Mayor Burke thanked and applauded the McGlynn teachers. Ms. Douglas thanked Mr. Belson for the apology and the School Committees support.

Melanie McLaughlin and Angela Maunsel Moore were given permission to speak. Ms. McLaughlin spoke about the need for more family and community engagement. She presented ideas of how this can be achieved. She mentioned that the special meeting on April 26th was not well publicized and many more community members would have attended if they were aware of such. Members voiced their concerns and comments on the subject of the continuation of the Superintendent's contract until June 30.

Angela Maunsel Moore continued with discussion about the succession plan. She said that if the Superintendent is unable to conduct his job then the Deputy would take over – that is what the old plan says. A succession plan was never properly done even though when she asked two years ago they produced the document in place. Committee members commented on the succession plan and the best plan for the Medford schools until June 30.

Recommendation to Reject School Choice

Superintendent Belson reported that under current school law, a school district is assumed to be accepting school choice students for SY 2018-2019, unless the School Committee votes to the contrary. Consequently, I must report an official vote of the Medford School Committee to the Department of Education in June 2018. Otherwise, the Medford School Committee will be obligated to participate in the School Choice Program for the upcoming school year. The School Choice program I am referring to is the external version, not the intradistrict program of choice. After careful consideration, it is my recommendation that the Medford School Committee vote

not to participate in the School Choice Program for SY 2018-2019. This has been our position since the beginning of the program. If we were to participate, we would have to accept students from other communities in the Commonwealth for baseline tuition, which could be well below the actual cost of the services that may occur. Such acceptances would be on a seat-available basis and could also affect enrollments selectively throughout the district, and as a result, trigger costs which would add to our budgetary burden. Furthermore, the Medford School Committee has continuously expressed a desire to emphasize servicing Medford students, and to concentrate our efforts in that direction. Lastly, by rejecting this provision, we do not compromise our ability to work with students in our special education programs or our Chapter 74 vocational programs, which are beneficial to our overall program and financial position.

On the motion of Ms. Van der Kloot seconded by Mr. Ruseau to reject School Choice for school year 2018-2019:

Roll Call:

Yea: 7 DiBenedetto, Kreatz, Mustone, Ruggiero, Ruseau, Van der Kloot, Burke

Nay: 0

Absent: 0

Report on Middle School SY 2018-2019 Enrollment and Selection

Deputy Superintendent Beverly Nelson presented the report. She reported that it has been the protocol since the new middle schools opened in 2001 that grade 5 parents could select a preference school for their children entering the middle schools. This system worked well for many years with sometimes a slight imbalance of numbers between the two schools. There were years that the McGlynn had slightly more students entering grade 6 than the Andrews; other years the Andrews had slightly more students selecting that school. This past school year this selection system resulted in a large imbalance. There are 43 more grade 6 students currently enrolled at the Andrews than the McGlynn. Additionally, some families did not get their choice of the Andrews due to the fact that forms were not received or came into the Parent Center after the deadline. At this time it appears that the numbers will be mirror this year's numbers as students move to grade 7 and the imbalance of grade 6 students at the Andrews will continue into grade 7. This year recognizing that we needed to have more balance in numbers in the schools we made the following changes to the middle school selection process:

1. In past years parents could return selection forms in a variety of ways. They could be returned to the school that the child was attending or returned in person or by mail to the Parent Information Center located at Medford High School. This year we put in place a return procedure that was uniform and forms were returned only to the elementary school that the child was attending. In addition to bringing consistency to the process it allowed us to better track forms and provide parents with a receipt that their form was returned. The deadline for returns was April 2.
2. The open houses were streamlined so that the presentation was the same for each school. Deputy Superintendent Beverly Nelson and Director of Curriculum and Instruction Bernadette Ricciardelli facilitated those uniform presentations that were well attended and received positive feedback.
3. The School Committee voted this year that although parents would initially be able to choose one of the two middle schools if there was an imbalance in numbers the school

district would hold a partial lottery. Letters were sent to parents explaining this two part process. Based on the returns we have received there is an even greater imbalance in families requesting the Andrews than last year. There are fifty-four (54) more students requesting the Andrews. According to the School Committee decision this calls for a partial lottery to be held.

We look for the Committees to affirm their decision to hold a partial lottery or to discuss it further. Please be aware however that i families are eager to know the school their children will attend and principals need enrollment numbers in order to begin the scheduling that takes place this time of year.

Discussion:

Mr. Ruseau asked if parents that did not return their forms were contacted. Ms. Nelson answered that she is not sure but will find out. Mr. Ruseau said that reviewing this report was not fun because of the imbalance. He suggested sending $\frac{1}{2}$ of the students from each elementary to each middle school. Ms. Van der Kloot would like to move on appointing the principal at the McGlynn that is #1. She said that a strong principal could see changes in numbers. We need to target the 21 students. Superintendent Belson said that people need to weigh their personal life etc. The McGlynn class size is small and that may be attractive to some. His suggestion over the next two weeks is to talk to the acting principals and on May 21st we need to act. Ms. Mustone commented that the McGlynn teachers mentioned the gifted and talented program and perhaps that will attract students. Ms. Nelson said that clubs were put in place. Student Tseng commented that unknown leadership probably is a big part of it. He suggested highlighting achievement of McGlynn students to attract more students. Ms. Mustone asked if some of the EL students could be sent to the Andrews. Ms. DiBenedetto said what we need is a short term plan for next year and then a long term one. Ms. Van der Kloot said that if the principal takes the position perhaps he may be able to reach out to parents

On the motion of Ms. Van der Kloot seconded by Mr. Ruggiero to table the paper until May 21st
Vote:

Yes: 7
No: 0
Absent: 0

Report on Trainer Issue and MIAA Policy Related to Soccer Game at Beverly High School
Superintendent Belson reported that the following correspondence is intended to provide follow-up information regarding the soccer injury that occurred during the game with Beverly High School this fall:

Consultation with the MIAA tells us that the organization considers the situation to be a local matter. The requirement to provide certified trainers does not cover all sports. Football and hockey do require a trainer to be present, but other sports do not. This includes soccer. The MIAA suggests that coaches and referees must take responsibility to determine if a player should not re-enter a game after an injury. The cost for certified trainers at every game would be prohibitive. As a result, Medford will intensify its training of our coaches and consider hiring an assistant trainer for certain sports to supplement our current staffing. Coaches will be instructed to exclude any Medford player who suffers a concussion or other major injury unless the player

is properly examined and clearer by a qualified trainer. Any student who suffers such an injury will require a written follow-up report and a subsequent examination by a qualified physician. It is also important to note that under MIAA rules (56.4) that a trainer, if present, is responsible for both teams when the medical person for the visiting team is not on site.

The Beverly Public Schools has indicated that they will not be re-hiring their current trainer going forward. They have advertised for a contracted training service for next year. The Medford Public Schools will initiate a discussion with the Northeast Conference schools on the issue of appropriate Trainer coverage. I believe that the above steps are a significant response to the issue. Additional steps may emerge. We would like to thank Ms. Simeonidis for her diligence on this matter. Our on field camera evidence and subsequent investigation supports her interpretation of the events at Beverly. We appreciate her commitment to ensuring safety for student athletes.

Discussion:

Mr. Ruseau commented that MIAA is saying that financial cost is more important than student safety. He is very disturbed by the statement. Mr. Ruggiero stated that soccer has a large concussion risk.

On the motion of Ms. Mustone seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot the report was accepted and placed on file.

Vote:

Yes: 7
No: 0
Absent: 0

Report on Partnership with Lesley University

Superintendent Belson reported that the City of Medford and the Medford Public Schools in conjunction with Lesley University of Cambridge Massachusetts are completing details for a mutually beneficial partnership. Lesley University is an outstanding institution of higher learning with strong specializations in the fields of education, human development, and technology. The following factors make a partnership between Lesley and Medford compelling for a long term, mutually beneficial, sustainable relationship:

- Lesley and MPS are geographically close enough to facilitate interaction and participation
- Both institutions share significantly common interests and missions
- There are substantial financial incentives to both parties for collaboration
- Opportunities exist and other can be created for expanded mutually beneficial collaboration
- Both Lesley and MPS have strong interest in professional development
- Field based experiences for graduates and undergraduates will be beneficial to both institutions
- Enrollment at Lesley by Medford students and professionals will provide quality education at an affordable private school price and will help the university with maintaining enrollment in a competitive environment

- Joint Grant Opportunities can be explored and secured on topics of mutual interest
- Qualified Lesley graduates can help to fill professional opening in the Medford Schools
- Workshops, conferences and special presentations can be developed that are mutually beneficial
- Lesley has several programs that address include inclusive practices, social and emotional learning, and technical education

Additionally the partnership will involve an opportunity to upgrade our gymnasium with a wooden floor and other improvements. We in return will allow Lesley to use the facility when it is not being used by our programs. They will pay for the renovations, maintenance and related security. At this stage we have been meeting with high level university officials including the President. We will keep you informed as our collaboration goes forward.

Discussion:

Ms. DiBenedetto said that maybe we should have heard about this sooner and requested the report be tabled until more information is presented.

Roll Call:

Yea: 2 DiBenedetto, Kreatz
 Nay: 5 Mustone, Ruggiero, Ruseau, Van der Kloot, Burke
 Absent: 0

On the motion of Ms. Van der Kloot seconded by Ms. DiBenetto to move the paper to a Committee of the Whole for further discussion regarding the impact and usage of our schools.

Vote:

Yes: 7
 No: 0
 Absent: 0

Report on ALICE Program Feedback

Assistant Superintendent Diane Caldwell presented the report. She reported the following results of the survey:

Key Points

- Teachers have options in a crisis situation
- Lots of environmental considerations
- Put students in a safe place, then alert authorities
- Can learn developmentally appropriate responses
- District-wide plan is necessary and collaboration with fire and police essential
- ALCE can be used anywhere and tailored to your current situation
- ALICE is using common sense
- Used in over 100 schools in Massachusetts
- Clear language options, drills 2x per year, schools need individualized plans

- Hide, run or fight
- Definition of acronym ALICE
- Call police instead of 911-quicker response
- Key elements of the program
- Lock downs effective

Benefits of Alice:

- Options for safety
- Different solutions for various age groups
- Alerting staff with common language
- Strategies to respond
- Well-coordinated approach to handling a threat
- Can be customized in each building
- Constructive discussion/training of how to handle a shooter
- Improved feelings of preparedness
- Provides options for response
- Pro-active approach
- Common, practiced response
- Awareness/assessment for vulnerabilities
- Sense of being proactive
- Everyone is trained and protocols is the same across the district
- Giving teachers the choice of how to respond

Alice Concerns:

- Cost
- Timeline for approval and training
- Subjective decisions of staff and temperaments of individuals making decisions
- Reservations at the elementary level and the raised level of anxiety for students while practicing
- All technology resources need to work to keep ALICE in working order
- Timetable moving forward
- Lack of practice, lack of upkeep with training
- Physical challenges for some staff and students
- Concerns about alerting staff
- Need to do a full security review
- How will plans be re-assessed?
- Some staff could become paralyzed with fear
- Adequate training and support
- Improving communication throughout the building
- Scare or frighten the kids

- Parent input
- Lack of cell service in schools
- Lack of communication in classrooms and to the main office

Suggestions for future district trainings related to school safety and security

- Check cameras
- Security is up to date and training is effective
- Classrooms with bullet proof glass
- What other programs are available?
- Training for students
- Meetings on communication, what to do if...
- Additional school resource officers
- Training staff on identification of students presenting with maladaptive thoughts
- How best to set up classrooms
- Everyone needs to be responsible for security
- Give staff a list of comprehensive options
- All drills should be taken seriously
- Create potential preventative measures
- Meet to review each building's safety measures
- Mental health of students
- Mental health of students
- Check video of ALICE in action
- Less expensive options
- Build a better relationship with police department
- Implementation as soon as possible

Discussion:

Mr. Ruseau said that he thought Medford was the only district not using ALICE but learned there are more. Ms. Van der Kloot would like to talk to the Superintendent elect about this program and keep it going.

On the motion of Mr. Ruggiero seconded by Ms. DiBenedetto to accept the report and place on file:

Vote:

Yes: 7
No: 0
Absent: 0

Pre Budget Report – Mathematics

Director of Mathematics Carolyn Joy presented the report.

Program Description

- K-12 mathematics curriculum aligned to the *2017 MA Curriculum Framework*
- Instructional practices and aligned program materials
- Mathematics instructional staff
 - Middle School – 13
 - High School – 15

Highlights of SY2017-2018

- K-12 curriculum revision
- Middle School program review
- Implementation of a new high school mathematics program for Algebra I, Geometry and Algebra II
- K-12 Professional Development focused in best practices for mathematics instruction
- Integration of students in the mathematics academic program
- Collaborations and Outreach
 - Massachusetts Institute of Technology, Tufts University, Wentworth Institute, Harvard University School of Education, Midé Technology
 - Parent/guardian participation and communications

Use of Funding for SY2017-2018

- Textbooks for new high school adoption
- Instructional materials to support the mathematics program K-12
- Office supplies for departmental operations

Funding Requests for SY2018-2019

- Level funding for instructional materials, textbooks and office supplies
- Textbook request includes a third payment for the high school *Algebra I–Geometry–Algebra II* program of \$39,260.40
- McGlynn Middle School Mathematics Lab Teacher

Discussion:

Mr. Ruseau asked what the math coaches do. Ms. Joy answered that they go into the classroom to assist the teachers with lessons or to improve upon the teachers practice. Members congratulated Ms. Joy and thanked her for her many years of service. Mr. Ruggiero asked if we participate in any math competitions. Ms. Joy said that we have a high school math team but we do not do the math competitions.

On the motion of Ms. DiBenedetto seconded by Mr. Ruggiero the report was accepted and placed on file.

Vote:

Yes: 7
No: 0
Absent: 0

Recommendation to Accept Gift from the Jae S. Lim Foundation

Ms. Joy stated that the Jae S. Lim Foundation has generously offered a gift of \$3,000 to Medford High School to encourage students to engage in rigorous mathematics and science studies. The gift recognizes students for academic excellence in these subjects. Acceptance of the gift requires announcement to sophomores in the Spring of 2018 to promote awareness. Two prizes of \$1,000 each are presented to juniors who demonstrate top performance in mathematics and in science for the 2018-2019 school year. An additional \$1,000 is designated for administrative costs at the discretion of the awarding committees and Headmaster. The mathematics awarding committee will consist of the director and teachers of the mathematics department. The science awarding committee will consist of the director and teachers of the science department. Criteria and selection will meet with the Headmaster's approval. This is the second year that the Jae S. Lim Foundation offered the gift to Medford High School. The first awarding of prizes to members of the junior class will take place on Thursday, May 17th at the annual Academic Awards Evening at Medford High School.

On the motion of Ms. DiBenedeto seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot to accept the gift and send a letter of appreciation:

Roll Call:

Yea: 7 DiBenedetto, Kreatz, Mustone, Ruggiero, Ruseau, Van der Kloot, Burke

Nay: 0

Absent: 0

The committee would also like to recognize the recipient of the award at an upcoming meeting.

Pre Budget Report – Health and Physical Education

Supervisor Rachel Perry presented the report.

Overview of Department

Health education K-12

Middle schools: 1 teacher

High schools: 2 teachers

Physical education K-12

Elementary schools: 5 teachers

Middle schools: 4 teachers

High schools: 3 teachers

Use of Funding SY 17-18

- PE & Health- Maintenance of equipment- funding used to maintain the fitness center equipment, inspection of high and low elements courses at the middle schools, and upholstery of fitness center equipment.
- PE & Health – Travel – funding used to attend a physical education conference and workshops.
- PE & Health – funding used to purchase office supplies
- PE & Health – Textbooks- funding used to purchase the elementary and middle school Michigan Model curriculum kits.

- PE & Health – Educational supplies- funding used to purchase physical education equipment and health education supplies.

Accomplishments:

- Received the Youth Opioid Prevention grant, used to provide all elementary teachers with the Michigan Model curriculum kit.
- Received the USA field hockey grant for all 4 elementary schools, providing curriculum and field hockey equipment to each school.
- Received the Game Change grant, providing anti violence training to high school and middle school students.
- Introduced the Lifeguard training course as a physical education elective at the high school.
- Added Yoga units to the K-8 physical education curriculum.

Requests for budget SY 18-19

- Level funding for travel, office supplies, text books, educational supplies, maintenance of equipment & fitness center supervision.
- Increase district Health/Physical education staffing by 2.0.
 - 1.0 health education position at the middle school level to afford students at both middle schools the full health curriculum.
 - 1.0 Increase physical education staffing for an adaptive physical education teacher to meet the needs of the special education students across the district

Discussion:

Mr. Ruseau commented that he is surprised to see that the Brooks and McGlynn only have one teacher and the Columbus has 1.5 – why? Ms. Caldwell answered that they have to balance specialists in the buildings. Superintendent Belson replied that it is the scheduling of specialists classes. Ms. Mustone asked if there is a plan for adaptive phys ed and how would it work. Ms. Perry answered that we can pull out the student or work collaborately with the teachers.

On the motion of Mr. Ruggiero seconded by Ms. Kreatz the report was accepted and placed on file:

Vote:

Yes: 7
 No: 0
 Absent: 0

Financial Report

Director of Administration and Finance Kirsteen Patterson presented the report. Ms. Patterson reported that As we approach the final two months of FY2018 we are projecting a balanced budget for the fiscal year. This has been a very challenging year as we have had to deal with multiple unexpected and/or increased cost factors. Still, resourceful development and application of supplemental revenue will enable the school system to meet its obligations barring any more unforeseen circumstances or assessments from entities beyond our control. As we prepare for the upcoming fiscal year budget process we will need to augment several accounts and sustain our resource/revenue generation abilities. New expenditures must be carefully prioritized and choices will have to be made. As you are aware, we are in collective bargaining

with our union personnel. Every year at this time we freeze discretionary funds to monitor balances through year end. There are several unexpected additional budget drivers that are being carried without known end dates with Security over-time as a prime example. The following is a list of items that have been incurred post budget approval for fiscal year 2018:

1. Regular Transportation slated to reduce a bus for FY18 but had to add more than one route back into the schedule for the NewComers program, additional after school runs and the new Columbus after school tutoring program.
2. Homeless transportation continues to grow, despite efforts to mitigate costs by utilizing mileage reimbursements, shared rides and consolidations
3. Audit expense now being charged to schools
4. Specialized one-to-one nurses for severe need students
5. Additional staffing to support the consolidation of the High School/Vocational School (Assistant Principal and Admin Assistant)
6. Security Over-Time

The general fund operating budget for FY18 is \$56,431,000 of which 82% or \$46,235,563 has been expended and/or encumbered to date. The approved free cash vote for security and E-rate items has been included for use increasing the budget to \$56,925,000. Ten-month bi-weekly employees have received 19 checks since August 28th, with a special run on 10/19/17 to accommodate issuing anticipated number of checks in the calendar year. All 12-month employees have received 22 paychecks since July 1st. The mid-year pay raise was effective on payroll dated 2/15/18 which creates the starting point for salary schedule COLA calculation going into negotiations.

Salaries – The Undistributed Salaries line has been expensed and disbursed to various account deficits. The SpEd categories have historically had no affiliated budget amount as much of those amounts are supported by outside revenue offsets. With the numerous retirements there will be some contractual vacation and/or sick buybacks within FY18 and to be planned for FY19 in accordance with CBA language.

Security – Security continues to be a priority with the district demonstrating its commitment to ensuring safety at all school site locations by virtue of added cameras, locks and door monitoring coverage. The unanticipated level of over-time in this category was not planned for in the FY18 budget and a long-term funding solution will need to be addressed.

Technology – The commitment of infusing \$102,000 of funds into the schools for technology was accommodated before school began in August. It provided additional support for testing and instructional support district-wide. The additional technology investment approved by both School Committee and City Council will provide further improvements for connectivity and bandwidth support by means district-wide upgrades to be implemented in the summer of 2018.

Utilities – We encumber utilities based on historical years usage and budget conservatively for unexpected occurrences in weather patterns. Natural gas rates, while continue to be favorable, have seen an increase in therm usage due to a very cold winter and therefore will have expenditures higher than the prior year which is the rationale for conservative projections. The second half of the expense activity includes January through March, which reflects 55,000 more

therms used than the same timeframe in 2017 [roughly 188,087therms compared to 242,528therms this year]. Electricity continues to be volatile in the marketplace and a slightly higher rate will begin in November 2018 locked in by city hall working with Power Options. Current rate through November 2018 is \$0.0882 per kWhr and the new rate will be \$.0931 per kWhr through 2021 as the supply cost. Our year-to-date actual expense is trending slightly higher than mid point last year [roughly \$47,949 higher], and will likely expend the full budget amount. The city and schools are in continual communication and cooperation identifying other energy improvements that could reduce overall costs. In summary, we are working hard to contain costs and minimize year end purchases to offset the identified challenges. As we prepare for the FY18-19 budget it is imperative to recognize the increases in major categories and prioritize with the anticipation of Collective Bargaining settlements, continued investment in security and transportation needs, as well as variable costs such as utilities and staffing needs that impact a planned budget.

Discussion:

Ms. DiBenedetto asked for a breakdown of security costs. Ms. Patterson said that overtime is about \$30,000. Ms. DiBenedetto said she would like to know the total cost of security. She would also like an update on Martha Coakley's report.

On the motion of Mr. Ruseau seconded by Mr. Ruggiero the report was accepted and placed on file.

Vote:

Yes: 7
No: 0
Absent: 0

Financial Report on Community Schools Program

Ms. Patterson presented the report. She stated that the packet includes many materials for Community Schools Programs including Building Rentals, Athletics, LoConte Rink, Edgerly Field, and the Swimming Pool. Program managers have provided summary reports consisting of recorded revenues/expenditures as well as anticipated bookings as these programs have continuous and ongoing activity. Also included is a full calendar of activities schedule from the reporting system, RSchoolToday Facility Scheduler, identifying scheduled events, bookings, rentals at all buildings from September 2017 to date (Note: the schedule reflects those events that are reported to Rachel Perry from the outside schools so there may be an item not captured if it was not shared). The Community Schools programs are Revolving Accounts that have continuous activity which rolls over to the next year with any applicable fund balance. Revolving funds are self-supporting program accounts that should have receipts/revenue to cover related expenses as per MGL and School Committee rental policy. The cost structure for a not-for-profit entity is a break-even model whose goal is to generate enough funds to grow and maintain the programs designated to operate. The intent of the programs is to provide services to the greater Medford community engaging with parents, staff, and outside organizations to facilitate a partnership between the schools and their constituents.

Edgerly Fields – The Edgerly Fields revolving program [321] account purpose collects rental fees for use of the fields. This program is anticipated to have a balance of roughly \$43,000

despite absorbing \$90,500 in bond interest and principal payments. The spring is an active rental season for this program and it is expected to have revenue collections further increasing the balance through the end of June.

Athletic – The Athletic revolving program [361] account purpose collects sports user fees and gate fees for various fall, winter, spring sports. While this fund currently shows an \$8,000 deficit, many of the spring user fees have not yet been collected and it is anticipated that the program will be at a break even status for year end. Participating in the North East Conference with 16 schools going up the north shore as far as Gloucester, has created additional burdens on the regular Athletic account but also impacts the revolving fund due to low home team attendance for gate receipts. Medford was previously in the Greater Boston League with local cities, however that conference dropped participation and the Mustangs needed a new competition group.

Community Schools – The Community Schools revolving program [362] account purpose collects rental fees for use of facilities at all buildings. While this program shows a fund deficit of \$29,778, there are many annual rental fees that have not been collected such as AIC, Tibetans, and Redemption Church as well as summer camp deposits providing an anticipated break-even status for year end. Community Schools engages many participants ranging from the Japanese Language School, not profit recreation groups, independent functions and the like that enhance the community involvement.

LaConte Rink – The LaConte Rink revolving program [365] account purpose collects rental fees for use of ice rink. While the rink shows a fund deficit of \$79,000 there are revenues that have not posted totaling \$73,600 that will bring the program toward a break even status at year end. Utility invoices will be paid then liquidated further reducing the deficit and the directors will work with City Hall and DPW to identify and plan for payroll expenses charged against this program.

Swimming Pool – The Swimming Pool revolving program [631] account purpose collects rental fees for use of pool by community groups and individuals for birthday parties and the like. The pool account sustained unpredictable charges including \$13,000 in lane and motor repairs as well as a spike in custodial over-time due to additional security measures enacted. The pool account shows an approximate deficit of \$44,000 but there are \$8,800 in physical deposits in transit and research with City Hall. Additionally, the spring months invoke more pool activity that generates additional revenue bringing the balance toward a break even status at year end. It is noteworthy that the pool was a known program area that may not generate the highest level of revenue but it is an important offering to the community recreation department and there is substantial use of the pool during open swim hours.

Discussion:

Ms. DiBenedetto would like to see personnel and payroll with these reports. Also a list of donation of use time on fields and how the time is tracked. Ms. DiBenedetto also asked for an update on when AIC and the Japanese School contracts including when they review, when they will pay and how much they pay. She also requested amounts for the community schools payrolls.

On the motion of Mr. Ruggiero seconded by Ms. DiBenedetto the report was accepted and placed on file.

Vote:

Yes: 7
No: 0
Absent: 0

Minutes of the Special Meeting April 26, 2018

On the motion of Ms. Van der Kloot seconded by Ms. DiBenedetto the minutes were approved
Vote:

Yes: 7
No: 0
Absent: 0

Committee of the Whole Minutes May 3, 2018

On the motion of Ms. Mustone seconded by Ms. Kreatz the minutes were approved
Vote:

Yes: 7
No: 0
Absent: 0

School Committee Resolution

Be it resolved, that the Medford School Committee express its sincere condolences to the family of Helen Purcell. Ms. Purcell was a school nurse in Medford for many years.

A moment of silence was held.

On the motion of Mr. Ruggiero seconded by Mr. Ruseau to go to Executive Session at 11:39 p.m. for cyber security matters, contract negotiations with pending unions, contract negotiations with non-unit and pending legal matters. The committee will not be returning to open session.

Roll Call:

Yea: 7 DiBenedetto, Kreatz, Mustone, Ruggiero, Ruseau, Van der Kloot, Burke
Nay: 0
Absent: 0

The meeting adjourned at 12:20 a.m.

Respectfully submitted:

Kathy Kreatz
Secretary

